



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 04- Role of Listening in Public Speaking

Prof. Binod Mishra

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



Hearing Vs Listening

- Hearing, according to Merriam-Webster is the “process, function, or power of perceiving sound; specifically: the special sense by which noises and tones are received as stimuli.”
- Listening, on the other hand, means “to pay attention to sound; to hear something with thoughtful attention and to give consideration.”(Merriam-Webster)

Hearing

Accidental

Involuntary

Effortless

Listening

Focused

Voluntary

Intentional

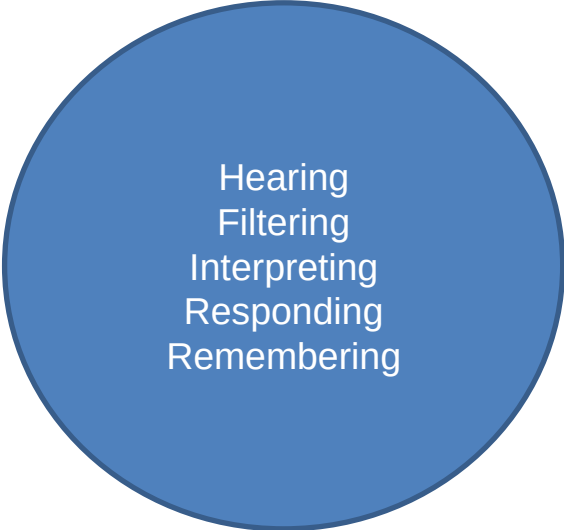
Listening as a *lost art*

Stephen Lucas illustrates the difference between listening and hearing as follows in the Chapter 3 of *The Art of Public Speaking* as follows:

- ❑ “*Hearing* is a physiological process, involving the vibration of sound waves on our eardrums and the firing of electrochemical impulses from the inner ear to the central auditory system of the brain.”
- ✓ We grasp only 50 percent of what we hear and we can remember only 10 percent of the original message.

Importance of Listening

- ✓ Listening is the other half of talking. In fact, listening is the **first step for speaking**.
- ✓ Of the four basic skills of learning, i.e. **L**istening, **S**peaking, **R**eading and **W**riting - it is evident that listening occupies the larger part.
- ✓ Studies reveal that students with the highest grade are usually great listeners showing great attention during lectures and discussions.
- ✓ It also plays a significant role in developing workplace culture and even forming healthy interpersonal relationships.



Hearing
Filtering
Interpreting
Responding
Remembering

Listening as a Process

- It begins with hearing.
- According to Ernest D. Nathan, “Perceptive listening is a conscious cognitive effort involving primarily the sense of hearing reinforced by other senses and leading to understanding. When perceptive listening is inspired by a sincere desire to understand, it becomes more than a sensory process. It is an attitude well expressed **as a listening spirit.**”



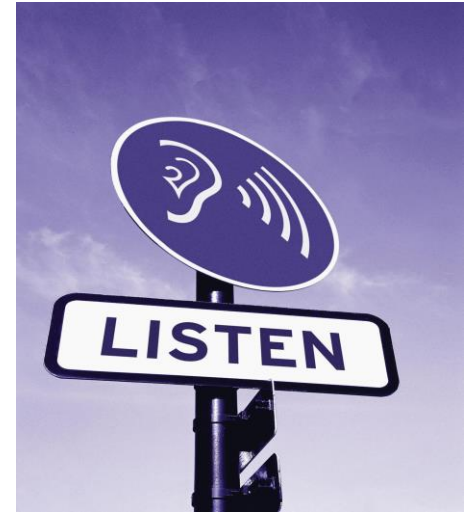
This Photo by Unknown Author is licensed under [CC BY-NC-ND](https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-nd/4.0/)

Effective Listening Situations

- ❖ Conversation
- ❖ Group discussion
- ❖ Negotiation
- ❖ Interviews
- ❖ Meetings
- ❖ Speeches

Advantages of Listening

- Builds trust and strong relationships
- Prevents you from missing important information
- Enables identification or anticipation of problems
- Empowers the individual as a leader
- Completes the Communication

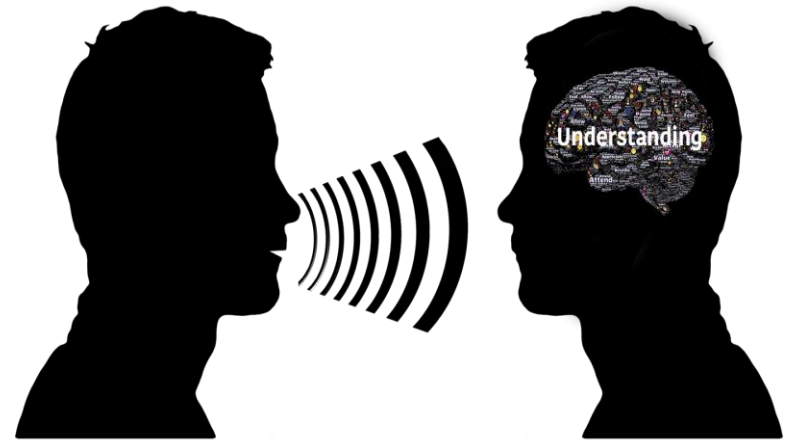


This Photo by Unknown Author is licensed under CC BY-SA-NC

Listening is also Communicating

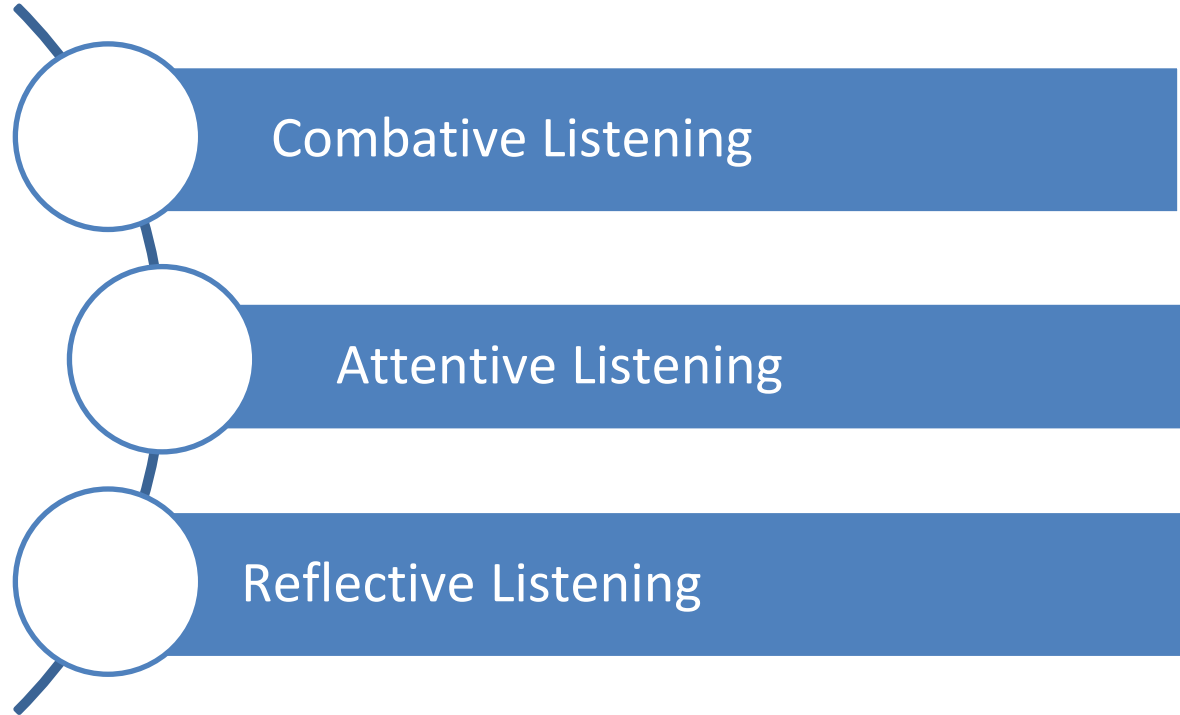
- Listening is the ability to accurately receive and interpret messages in the communication process.
- Listening is key to all effective communication. Without the ability to listen effectively, messages are easily misunderstood.

Active Listening



This Photo by Unknown Author is licensed under CC BY-SA

Basic Modes of Listening



➤ **Combative Listening**

Listeners tend to be more conscious of their own viewpoints than the content delivered by the speaker. They deliberately draw attention and are mostly immature listeners.

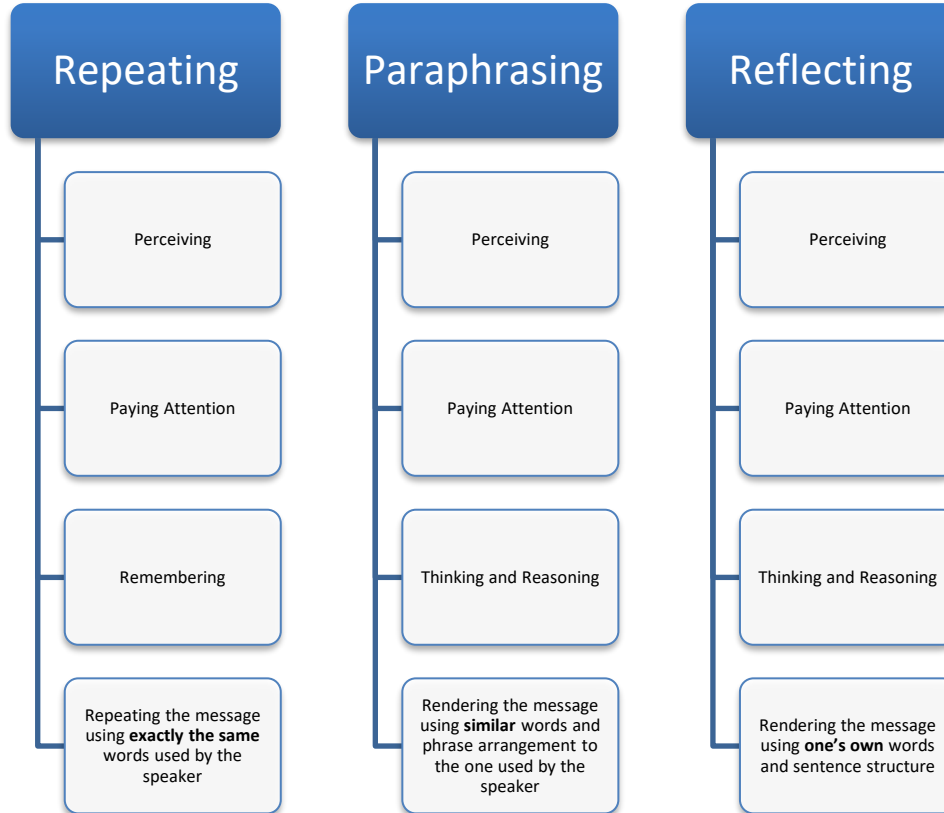
➤ **Attentive Listening**

Listeners have the patience to instill whatever is being uttered by the speaker. They neither check the facts presented by the speaker nor mistrust them. They lack independent thinking and easily get carried away by what has been said.

➤ **Reflective Listening** (most effective type of listening)

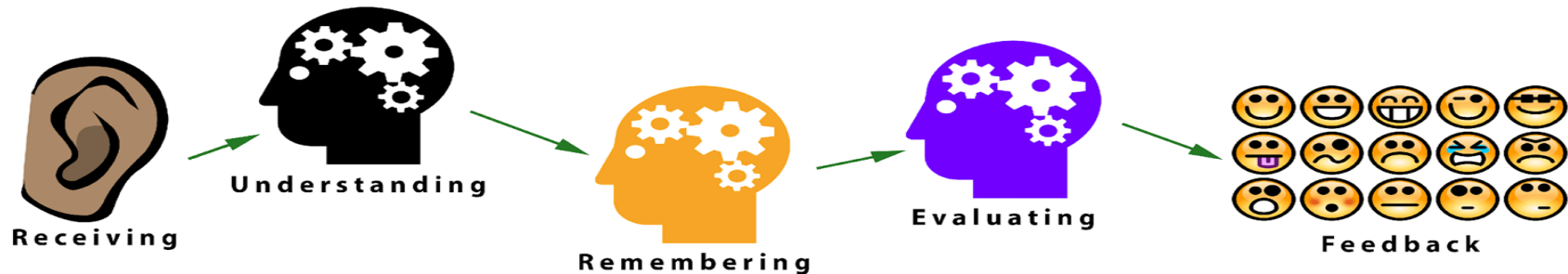
Listeners are alert, actively opine and evaluate everything delivered by the speaker and reciprocate in the best possible manner.

Degrees of Active Listening



Feedback in Active Listening

- Key component of Active Listening
- Corrective mechanism; helps an individual to learn how to match behaviour with original intention
- Active Listener should refrain from imposing unwelcomed responses



This Photo by Unknown Author is licensed under CC BY-SA

Advantages of Listening

- Listening is an essential element of learning.
- Child learns sounds before s/he learns to write.
- Linguists believe language is not taught but caught.
- Listening benefits the speaker as well as the listener.

Impediments to Listening

- ❑ Prejudging
- ❑ Ambiguity
- ❑ Illusion
- ❑ Rigidity
- ❑ Abstracting
- ❑ Slant
- ❑ Premature evaluation
- ❑ Hurried conclusions
- ❑ Cognitive dissonance

How to listen effectively?

- ✓ Pay full attention and respect.
- ✓ Listen actively - one thing at a time
- ✓ Focusing on the message than the details.
- ✓ Look out for evidence supporting the main message.
- ✓ Develop note-taking skills.

- ✗ Concentrate not on the speaker's delivery or appearances, but the speech.
- ✗ Avoid presumptions and judgements.
- ✗ Avoid distractions - both physical and mental.

“Hearing is through ears, but listening is through the mind.”

Thank You

Works Consulted

- <https://inpd.co.uk/blog/benefits-of-active-listening/>
- <https://www.skillsyouneed.com/ips/listening-skills.html>
- Lucas, Stephen. *The Art of Public Speaking*. McGraw-Hill Book Co., 2014.
- Nikitina, Arina. *Successful Public Speaking*, 2011
- Ross, Raymond. *Speech Communication*, Prentice-Hall Inc., 1977.
- Sharma, Sangeeta and Binod Mishra. *Communication Skills for Engineers and Scientists*. PHI Learning Pvt. Limited. 6th ed., New Delhi, 2015.
- Zaresky, David. *Public Speaking Strategy for Success*. 8th Edition, Pearson: New York, 2016.